get him bathed and all cleaned up and ready, even though it meant leaving Victoria. All our family came round to the hospital that evening. It was like having all the people you love most wrapped around you. Then, that night, I stayed. There wasn't another bed in the room; Victoria was in the hospital bed, because she still had the pipes and monitors connected from the operation, and Brooklyn was in his cot. I slept on the floor with a terrycloth for a cushion and my head pressed up against the door, so it couldn't be opened. Maybe we were a little nervous, but you can't ever know. All I was sure of was how happy I was: just me, Victoria and Brooklyn, breathing, sleeping together in that little room, through until morning.

Almost the first phone call I'd made was to Alex Ferguson, just to let him know there was another lad named Beckham about, and he was great. He's got sons of his own and I think he understood just how I was feeling. After the congratulations, he told me not to bother coming up to Manchester to train: just to stay with Brooklyn and Victoria and come back the day before the next game. I played against Chelsea on the Saturday and then drove back to London. At first, Brooklyn had trouble keeping his milk down. That evening, Victoria got him dressed up in this little green and white outfit and I arrived just in time to see his latest meal come up all over his clothes and the bed. It was like a special welcome for me, to the real fun of being a dad.

The day Victoria and Brooklyn came home was mad and, to be honest, I don't remember it as a good experience at all. You looked out of the window and someone had hung this huge banner across the shops opposite, which said: 'BROOKLYN THIS WAY'. We made arrangements with the hospital and with the police, who both did everything they could to help: a back way in for the car, curtains hung in the windows all around the back seats, everything we could think of to make trying to get past this army of press and photographers and well-wishers a bit less scary and upsetting for a baby boy, just a couple of days old, and his very tired mum. It turned into something like a military operation and, of course, when it came to doing my bit, I was all over the place. I'd never strapped in a baby's car seat. Snarling the straps, putting the thing in the wrong way round, trying to line up the buckles: in the end, the midwife had to do it for me.

We got settled in the car and then had to draw the curtains, which meant that—apart from hundreds of flashes from the cameras—we didn't really see the fuss that was going on until we got home and watched it on television. The press had positioned cars along the route, to hold us up so the snappers could get their pictures. The police, though, saw what was happening, which was dangerous for us and everybody else, and they closed off the main road to